Despite Everything, It's Still You

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/80069761.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-War, Sleep, Sleepy Cuddles, title is an undertale reference, POV Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra)

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Part 5 of Thank You SPOP!!!

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Despite Everything, It's Still You

by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

Despite everything, it's still you. The war is done. Adora and Catra won. A new day dawns and Adora and Catra must get up for a meeting.

(Final fic for the Thank You SPOP event)

Notes

Alright, my last fic for the Thank You SPOP event. I guess see end notes if you want. Thank you in advance for reading this fic.

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra and Glimmer were right: mornings *are* evil. There hadn't always been. There was a time when Adora could effortlessly rise before the day-moons. A time when she could run a mile around Bright Moon's palace before breakfast. A time when she could jump out of bed and immediately get onto the floor and start doing push-ups beside her bunk in the Horde, ignoring the grumbling and heated glares from Catra, who claimed that Adora's exercising had disrupted *her* sleep.

Adora didn't understand back then. She did now.

She used to relish in her early morning training. She had a goal back then though. In the Horde, early mornings meant time for preparation. She could further hone skills. She could do it away from prying and judgemental eyes.

In Bright Moon, early morning meant an escape. Neverending nightmares plagued her throughout her years in Bright Moon. Catra dying by her hand. She held Catra in those dreams. She watched the light in her eyes fade. She felt her body go limp.

She had nightmares of Glimmer and Bow dying by Catra's hand. She was always frozen in place in those dreams. Sometimes she was surrounded by nameless, faceless, Horde soldiers. She would hear a scream. She would hear either a panicked, grief-stricken, "Bow!" or "Glimmer!", and through the gaps of the soldiers' formations, she would watch one or even both of them fall. Catra would turn her head over her shoulder to make eye contact, she would smirk. Usually the nightmare would end there.

Sometimes she had nightmares of being useless. Of lifting the sword up, shouting her usual cry: *for the honor of Grayskull!* Only for the transformation to never happen. The Horde would close in on her and Shadow Weaver's form would appear.

She had nightmares of Shadow Weaver. She would hear that witch's voice echo in her nightmare. She would see her red, glowing eyes. Shadow Weaver's magic would surround her. It was

suffocating. It was burning. It was horrible. Those nightmares increased after Shadow Weaver's arrival in Bright Moon.

After the Portal Incident, all of her nightmares were related to that. Queen Angella. Catra, her face and body half consumed by darkness.

Mornings used to mean escape. Sleep used to mean pain. Now it didn't… Or rather, it didn't *all* the time.

It had only been two weeks since the Heart. Nightmares still came. Some nights she would bolt up, her brow sweaty, hair sticking to her forehead. On those nights, she would feel Catra's embrace around her tighten and would lie back down, lulled to a more peaceful sleep, surrounded by the rumble of Catra's purrs.

Now, Adora loved sleep (for the most part). She loved her bed. She relished being under her covers and the comforter. She relished being near Catra.

Purrs rumbled in her ears. Catra's arms wrapped around her. Her head was tucked under Adora's chin, safe and snug. A feeling of warmth spread through Adora. A smile flickered on her lips. She tightened her grip on Catra, embracing her even more. There was a soft and quieted *mrrp*. Adora's eyes sparkled at the sound. Catra's arms wrapped further around her.

Catra's purrs were not the only ones that filled the room. Melog was draped across them both. The rumble of their purrs almost surpassing Catra's. Their presence further trapped Adora in bed. Mornings really are evil. How could she possibly leave her bed?

Adora sighed and glanced over at the window. Sunlight streamed out between the white curtains. She had work to do. She *needed* to get up. She needed to get Catra up as well. Glimmer would need them *both* today.

"Hey, Catra," Adora whispered.

No response.

“Catra,” Adora repeated, just slightly louder than before. She gently jiggled Catra in her arms. She didn’t want to startle her awake. They were safe now. They *both* were.

“Catraaa…” Adora repeated a third time, her voice barely going up an octave.

Mrrp!

Adora’s eyes glowed with stars once more. Her heart clenched and she fought the urge to hold Catra even tighter and ignore the day. Ignore duty. Ignore Glimmer. Ignore Etheria. She had done her part to save it all. Why couldn’t she just ignore it all now? Would it really hurt anything if she just stayed in bed? Stayed and didn’t go to the meeting? Stayed and just remained cuddled up with Catra?

Adora exhaled. She barely registered that she had been holding her breath. *Yes. You must get up. The job is not finished yet.* She told herself.

“Hey, Catra,” she whispered once more, slowly and gently rocking Catra in her arms.

Mrrp!

She felt Catra move. She slowly released her grip on her. Catra’s head brushed against her chin as she untucked her head. Adora moved to sit up. Catra opened her eyes, blinking as sleep threatened to overtake her again.

“Hey, Adora,” she replied sleepily, her mismatched eyes flickering up to catch Adora’s gaze.

Adora smiled at her, warm and bright. If she didn’t know any better, she would have sworn that Catra had blushed under her smile. (Had she?!)

“Hey,” she greeted Catra warmly. “Daymoon’s up. We need to get up and get ready for the meeting with Glimmer.”

She heard Catra huff, no doubt annoyed.

Adora reached out and carefully shook Catra by her shoulder.

"Maybe I could talk to Glimmer about us taking tomorrow off?" Adora offered. She felt uncertain about making that request though. People in Etheria still needed help. Could she really afford to take a day off?

"Only if you promise, alright?" Catra said, flashing her a smile.

They were kids again. It was just them. Them against the Horde. Them against Etheria.

Nothing bad can really happen as long as we have each other.

You promise?

I promise

"I promise."

Catra's smile grew. She seemed satisfied.

"Good," she replied, slowly sitting up in bed. She stretched her arm over her head and yawned. "Alright," she moved her arm back down, "Let's get ready, I guess." Her enthusiasm dying as she realized she actually had to get out of bed now.

Catra glanced at her, her gaze seemingly uncertain. Adora grinned at her, which seemed to ease whatever thoughts were running through her mind. She grinned back and leapt out of the bed, and went for the bathroom.

Adora swung a leg off of the bed. She sat there for a moment, on the edge of the mattress. Out of the corner of her eyes, she saw her reflection in a mirror nearby. She glanced at it. The Horde. She-Ra. Bright Moon. The Rebellion. The Portal. Space. Prime. The Heart. So much had happened over the last few years.

Thanks to her healing powers, she didn’t bear many scars from the last few years. At least, not physical scars. Some wounds were deep. Some wounds would take time to heal. Adora looked at her reflection. Catra's voice from long ago echoed.

It's you!

Things were simpler back then. Adora smiled her reflection. Catra's voice was replaced by her own.

Despite everything, it’s still you…

End Notes

Thank you for reading! Any kudos and/or comments are always appreciated!

I discovered SPOP due to TikTok. I watched some clips and it looked like an interesting show, so I watched. I... I feel in love with the show. Growing up, I loved fantasy stories and chosen ones stories (I still do). Most of the stories I enjoyed though had male protagonist, which is okay! But it was amazing to watch She-Ra and see the tropes I love actually have a female protagonist! Adora is one of my favorite fictional characters now! She is extremely relatable, so it was nice to finally see that in a show.

I hope that it being taken off of Netflix is not the end of the show's existence or of the fandom. I have some more SPOP fics I wish to write and several that I need to finish.

Anyway, those are some of my thoughts and feelings on SPOP.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!